

Solving what matters: A Product Thinking Case Study

AngelOne is a leading Indian online stockbroking firm. It provides trading services across equities, currencies, and commodities. I chose AngelOne because as a user, I've observed its ambition to simplify investing for a large segment of India's population, especially first-time and young investors. I believe there's a significant opportunity to enhance their experience, specifically around guiding them through the initial complexities of the market and ensuring platform stability.

Product Vision

To be the most trusted and empowering financial partner for every Indian, enabling them to achieve their financial aspirations with confidence and ease through a seamless, intelligent, and supportive investment journey.

Product Mission

AngelOne's mission today is to democratize financial markets by providing a user-friendly, technology-driven platform that simplifies investing for millions of Indians, fostering financial literacy, and offering diverse investment opportunities with transparent practices.

Problem Statement

When I as a new or aspiring investor try to navigate the AngelOne app or seek assistance during critical trading moments, I want to understand complex financial concepts easily, execute trades reliably, and receive prompt, relevant support, but I struggle because the app interface can be cluttered for beginners, technical glitches occur during peak market hours, and customer support can be slow or difficult to reach, leading to missed opportunities, frustration, lack of confidence, and a potential abandonment of the platform or investing altogether.

Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD)

Core Job: When a retail investor wants to confidently grow my wealth by participating in financial markets, I hire AngelOne to provide a reliable, intuitive, and supportive platform that enables me to make informed investment decisions and execute transactions without unnecessary friction, so I can feel empowered and secure in my financial journey.

User Research Plan

To validate the identified problems, we would employ a mixed-methods approach focusing on understanding user behaviour and pain points.

1. User Interviews (15-20 participants):

- **Method:** Conduct one-on-one, semi-structured interviews with a mix of new AngelOne users (less than 6 months), active traders who have experienced glitches, and users who have interacted with customer support.
- **Focus:** Explore their initial onboarding experience, decision-making process for investments, common usage patterns, specific instances of frustration with the app's

complexity or performance, and their experiences with seeking help. We'd use open-ended questions to uncover underlying needs and emotional drivers.

- **Validation:** Look for recurring themes related to interface clarity, stability during peak times, and customer support responsiveness.

2. In-App Surveys (Pop-ups & Targeted):

- **Method:** Implement short, contextual surveys within the AngelOne app.
 - **Onboarding Survey:** A brief survey for new users after their first few interactions, asking about ease of understanding key features.
 - **Error Message Survey:** A pop-up survey appearing after a user encounters a technical glitch or an error message, asking about the impact and clarity of the message.
 - **Post-Support Interaction Survey:** A quick survey after a user closes a customer support ticket, asking about satisfaction with the resolution time and effectiveness.
- **Focus:** Quantify the frequency and severity of specific pain points identified in the problem statement. Gather feedback on feature clarity and support quality at scale.
- **Validation:** Collect quantitative data on user satisfaction levels for different parts of the journey, correlating it with identified pain points.

Persona Snapshot

Newbie Nidhi

About: Nidhi is a 24-year-old marketing executive from Nagpur, new to the world of investing. She's heard about stock market opportunities from friends and social media. She wants to start investing for long-term goals like buying a home or saving for her child's education in the future.



Goals:

- * To understand the basics of investing and stock markets.
- * To make her first few investments confidently without feeling overwhelmed.
- * To build a stable, long-term portfolio with minimal risk.

Frustrations:

- * The AngelOne app feels complex and intimidating with too many options.
- * Difficulty understanding financial jargon and market dynamics.
- * Unsure about which stocks or mutual funds to choose.
- * Worries about making a mistake and losing money.

Behaviours: Watches YouTube tutorials, reads beginner blogs, asks friends for advice. Prefers simple, guided experiences.

Needs: Simplified interface, clear explanations, guided investment paths, educational content.

Aspiring Ankit

About: Ankit is a 29-year-old software engineer from Bengaluru. He has some basic investment knowledge and enjoys actively trading during market hours. He wants to leverage market fluctuations for quick gains and learn more advanced trading strategies.



Goals:

- * To execute trades quickly and efficiently, especially during volatile periods.
- * To access real-time market data without delays.
- * To resolve technical issues or queries instantly to avoid missing opportunities.

Frustrations:

- * App lags or crashes during peak trading hours (e.g., opening bell).
- * Difficulty placing complex orders or using advanced charting tools seamlessly.
- * Long wait times or unhelpful responses from customer support when urgent issues arise (e.g., order not executed).
- * Fear of losing money due to technical glitches.

Behaviours: Checks market news constantly, uses advanced charting features, tracks specific stocks, engages in intraday trading.

Needs: High-performance app, reliable technical infrastructure, responsive and knowledgeable customer support, intuitive advanced features.

Customer Journey Map (CJM) - Newbie Nidhi: Making First Investment

Stage	Action	Thoughts & Feelings	Touchpoints	Pain Points	Opportunities
Awareness	Hears about investing from friends.	"Maybe I should start investing too. But where? What is it all about?"	Friends, Social Media	Feeling overwhelmed by the sheer volume of information.	Provide simple, relatable "Why Invest?" content.
Discovery	Downloads AngelOne app (friend's rec).	"Okay, I'm ready to explore. This app looks popular."	AngelOne App	Initial interface seems dense, confusing.	Clear, concise app introduction/tour.
Onboarding/KYC	Completes registration and KYC.	"This was pretty straightforward. Good."	AngelOne App	(Generally smooth, but some struggle with document uploads.)	Clear guidance for document submission.
Funding Account	Links bank and adds funds.	"Easy enough, just like any other UPI payment."	AngelOne App, Bank App		
Exploring App	Browses home screen, market watch.	"So many numbers, charts, and news! What does it all mean? Where do I even start?"	AngelOne App	Overwhelmed by information overload; irrelevant data for a beginner. No clear "start here" guidance.	Personalized dashboard for beginners. Guided walkthrough for first-time users. Simplified market overview.
Researching Stocks	Searches for "popular stocks" or "mutual funds."	"Okay, so there are options. But which one is good for me? What's a PE ratio? What's NAV?"	AngelOne App, Google	Information presented is too technical. Lack of beginner-friendly filters or recommendations. Fear of making a wrong choice.	"Beginner's Picks" or "Curated Portfolios" based on risk appetite. Glossary of terms. "Why this stock?" simplified explanations.
Making First Trade	Attempts to buy a share/MF.	"I think I found one. Now, how do I actually buy it? What are all these order	AngelOne App	Complex order types are confusing. Confirmation screens lack clarity for	Step-by-step guided buying process. Simplified "Buy" button for market orders.

		types (Limit, Market, Stop Loss)?"		beginners. Fear of incorrect entries.	Clear explanations for order types during selection.
Post-Trade Review	Checks portfolio.	"Is it correct? Did my order go through? What if the value goes down?"	AngelOne App	Anxiety about the trade. Lack of immediate, simple feedback on order status beyond "executed."	Simple "My First Investment" success message. Easy access to basic portfolio performance metrics.
Seeking Help	Has a query about portfolio value.	"My portfolio value changed, why? I need to ask someone."	AngelOne App	Cannot find clear FAQ or direct chat support easily. Navigating customer support options is cumbersome. Long wait times. Unhelpful bots.	Prominent in-app FAQ for common beginner questions. AI-powered chatbot for instant answers. Easy access to human support when needed.

Opportunity Sizing

This problem affects a significant portion of AngelOne's user base, as approximately **90% of its 27.5 million clients are young millennials, and 85% are first-time entrants to the financial market**. These segments are precisely the ones most likely to be overwhelmed by complexity, frustrated by technical issues, and reliant on clear, responsive support.

- **Number of Users Affected:** Roughly $27.5 \text{ million} \times 85\% = 23.375 \text{ million}$ users. Even a fraction of these experiencing consistent pain points represents a massive user base.
- **Business Value:**
 - **Reduced Churn:** Addressing these pain points could significantly reduce churn rates among new and aspiring investors, preventing them from abandoning investing due to a poor initial experience.
 - **Increased Engagement & LTV:** A smoother, more reliable, and supportive experience will lead to increased app usage, higher trading volumes (as confidence grows), and greater lifetime value per customer.
 - **Improved Brand Reputation:** Positive word-of-mouth and reviews, especially from first-time investors, will enhance AngelOne's brand image and attract more users in a competitive market.
 - **Competitive Advantage:** Differentiating through superior user experience and support can provide a significant edge against competitors like Zerodha and Groww.

- **Monetization Opportunities:** A more engaged user base is more likely to explore other AngelOne products and services (e.g., advisory tools, mutual funds) once their confidence builds.

Prioritization (Kano Model)

We will use the Kano Model to prioritize potential solutions, focusing on Newbie Nidhi's and Aspiring Ankit's pain points.

Feature/Solution	Kano Category	Rationale	Priority
1. App Stability & Performance Improvements (esp. during peak hours)	Basic (Must-be)	Users expect the app to work flawlessly. Crashes or lags during critical trading moments cause extreme dissatisfaction. Its absence is a deal-breaker. Its presence is merely expected.	Highest
2. Simplified "Beginner Mode" Interface	Performance	The more intuitive and less cluttered the interface is for new users, the more satisfied they will be. This directly addresses Nidhi's pain point and improves learning curves. Satisfaction scales with simplicity.	High
3. In-App AI-Powered Chatbot for Instant FAQs & Guidance	Performance	The better the chatbot is at answering common queries and guiding users, the higher their satisfaction with support. It directly addresses the long wait times and bot limitations experienced by both personas.	High
4. Contextual Tooltips & Jargon Glossary	Performance	The more clearly financial terms and tool functionalities are explained within the app, the better users like Nidhi will understand and utilize the platform. More clarity leads to more satisfaction.	Medium
5. Curated "First Investment" Pathways	Delighter	For new users like Nidhi, offering predefined, low-risk investment paths (e.g., "Start your SIP," "Invest in Top 50 Stocks") would be a pleasant surprise. It removes choice paralysis and instills confidence beyond basic expectations.	Medium
6. Real-time Status Updates for Support Tickets	Basic (Must-be)	Users expect to know the status of their queries. A lack of updates or transparency creates significant frustration. Providing this is a fundamental expectation for effective customer service.	High

7. "Why this Stock?" Simplified Explanations	Performance	Offering concise, easy-to-understand summaries of why a particular stock might be a good investment (based on basic metrics) directly enhances a beginner's ability to make decisions, increasing their satisfaction. More explanations, more confidence.	Medium
8. Interactive Tutorials & Simulations	Delighter	Providing interactive guides or a simulated trading environment would be an unexpected bonus, allowing users to learn and practice without risk. This goes beyond the core functional expectation and drives engagement.	Low-Medium
9. Direct Call/Video Support in-app	Performance	While a chatbot handles many queries, direct human interaction for complex or urgent issues is a key performance indicator for customer support. The easier it is to get to a human, the better the experience.	Medium

Prioritization Rationale:

Based on the Kano Model, our highest priority (and part of the MVP) should be to ensure the **Basic** features are robust. **App Stability and Performance** is paramount. Without it, even the best "delighters" won't prevent churn, as Ankit's frustration shows. We also prioritize **Real-time Status Updates for Support Tickets** as a basic expectation.

Next, we focus on high-impact **Performance** features. **Simplified "Beginner Mode"** and an **AI-Powered Chatbot** directly address the core problem of complexity and slow support, impacting millions of first-time users. These offer proportional increases in satisfaction. Contextual tooltips and direct call support are also high-performance but might come slightly later than the most critical ones.

Finally, **Delighters** like "Curated Pathways" and "Interactive Tutorials" are important for differentiation and long-term user stickiness, but they should be built upon a solid foundation of basic and strong performance features.

MVP Idea

The smallest possible solution to launch and test whether we solve the core problem (clutter for beginners, basic support, stability issues) would be a **"Lite Mode" for New Investors coupled with an enhanced In-App Quick Help System.**

MVP Components:

1. **"Lite Mode" Toggle:** A prominent toggle (e.g., on the dashboard or in settings) that, when activated, simplifies the main dashboard and navigation for new users.
 - o **Simplified Dashboard:** Shows only essential information: Portfolio value, top mutual funds, top index-linked stocks, and a clear "Invest Now" button.

- **Reduced Navigation:** Removes complex trading options (e.g., derivatives, commodities) from the primary navigation. These can be accessed through a "Pro Mode" or "Advanced Features" section if needed.
- **Guided First Investment:** A simple, step-by-step wizard for making the first investment in a mutual fund or a popular large-cap stock.

2. Basic In-App Smart Chatbot:

- **Instant FAQ Resolution:** A chatbot accessible from the Lite Mode dashboard, capable of answering the top 20-30 most common beginner queries (e.g., "How to add funds?", "What is SIP?", "How to buy a stock?").
- **Direct Link to Human Support:** If the chatbot cannot resolve the query, it provides a clear and easy path to connect with human customer support via chat or direct call, with expected wait times.

3. Core Performance Monitoring & Alerts (Internal):

- Implement enhanced internal monitoring for app performance, especially during market open/close.
- Automated alerts for the ops team when latency spikes or errors occur, allowing for quicker resolution. (This is a "basic" must-have improvement that may not be directly visible to users but impacts their experience significantly.)

Why this is an MVP: It directly tackles the primary pain points of clutter for beginners and initial support needs, while also ensuring the underlying technical stability that all users expect. It provides tangible value without requiring a full overhaul of the app. We can measure adoption of "Lite Mode" and reduction in support tickets for basic queries.

Roadmap Format

We would represent our solution using a **Goal-Based Roadmap** with a **Now-Next-Later** time horizon. This format aligns features with key user outcomes and provides flexibility.

- **Now (Current Quarter/Next 1-2 Sprints):** Focus on foundational improvements and the initial MVP.
 - **Goal:** Enhance first-time user confidence and reduce immediate friction.
 - **Initiatives:**
 - Launch "Lite Mode" with simplified dashboard & navigation.
 - Deploy Basic In-App Smart Chatbot (FAQ focus).
 - Implement enhanced internal performance monitoring for critical trading hours.
- **Next (Next 1-2 Quarters):** Build upon the MVP, addressing more performance-oriented features and deepening user support.
 - **Goal:** Improve user understanding and satisfaction with core investing activities.
 - **Initiatives:**

- Expand Chatbot capabilities (contextual guidance, common trading queries).
- Integrate Contextual Tooltips & Jargon Glossary.
- Introduce "Why this Stock?" Simplified Explanations.
- Optimize backend infrastructure further for peak load resilience.
- **Later (Beyond 2 Quarters):** Explore delighters and more advanced features that enhance the overall value proposition and differentiate AngelOne.
 - **Goal:** Drive advanced engagement and foster long-term loyalty.
 - **Initiatives:**
 - Develop Curated "First Investment" Pathways based on user profiles.
 - Introduce Interactive Tutorials & Simulated Trading Environment.
 - Explore in-app direct call/video support.
 - Personalized content recommendations (leveraging AI).

AI Thinking

AI can significantly enhance the AngelOne product and support our proposed solutions in several ways:

1. AI-Powered User Feedback Analysis:

- **Application:** Utilize Natural Language Processing (NLP) to analyze customer support tickets, chat transcripts, app store reviews, and social media comments.
- **Improvement:** Automatically identify recurring pain points, trending issues (e.g., specific stock glitches, common confusion points), and sentiment. This helps product teams quickly pinpoint areas needing improvement and prioritize fixes, reducing reliance on manual review of vast data.

2. Intelligent Personalized Recommendations:

- **Application:** Based on a user's investment history, risk profile, educational content consumption, and stated goals, an AI engine can recommend suitable stocks, mutual funds, or learning modules.
- **Improvement:** For Newbie Nidhi, this means "smart" suggestions for low-risk mutual funds aligned with her goals, rather than overwhelming market data. For Aspiring Ankit, it could be personalized alerts on specific stocks or market trends relevant to his trading style. This makes the "researching stocks" stage of the CJM much more efficient and less intimidating.

3. Enhanced In-App Smart Chatbot (beyond MVP):

- **Application:** Evolve the MVP chatbot into a highly intelligent virtual assistant.
- **Improvement:**

- **Contextual Understanding:** The chatbot can understand the user's current screen and context within the app (e.g., if they are on a stock detail page, it can answer "What is this stock's PE ratio?" directly).
- **Proactive Assistance:** It can pop up proactively with tips or explanations if it detects a user is struggling or hovering over a complex feature.
- **Sentiment Analysis:** Identify user frustration or urgency in chat and prioritize escalation to human support if needed.

4. **Predictive Analytics for System Stability:**

- **Application:** Machine learning models can analyze historical data on app usage patterns, network traffic, and system performance metrics.
- **Improvement:** Predict potential peak load times or identify early warning signs of system stress, allowing AngelOne's technical team to proactively scale infrastructure or allocate resources to prevent crashes and lags experienced by users like Ankit during crucial trading moments.

5. **Automated Content Generation & Summarization:**

- **Application:** AI can summarize complex financial news articles or company reports into digestible, beginner-friendly nuggets.
- **Improvement:** This directly supports "Newbie Nidhi's" need for simplified explanations and helps her make informed decisions without getting lost in jargon. It can also generate personalized educational content based on her learning progress.